

Requested Changes — What Was Done

Artist Prospecting System · Point-by-point response to the six actions · 26 July 2026

Each of your six points below, with what the machine did before, what it does now, and the measured result. Where something is not finished I have said so plainly rather than describing the plan as though it were done.

1. Gallery detection

YOU ASKED FOR

“Verify that the machine never classifies a gallery as having no artists when artists are actually present. This includes galleries where artists may be behind pagination, “Load More”, infinite scroll, JavaScript-rendered content, tabs, alphabetical sections, or similar navigation.”

BEFORE

One answer covered two completely different situations. A gallery whose website could not be read, and a gallery genuinely without artists, both came back as **“no artists”**. Nothing distinguished them, so an unreadable site was silently counted as empty.

CHANGED TO

Six separate verdicts. **“Cannot verify”** and **“no artists”** are now **different answers**. A gallery that cannot be fully read is reported as such, with the reason — site unreachable, nothing returned, stopped at a page limit, or artist pages found but names unreadable.

What the machine now reports	No.	Meaning
CANNOT VERIFY — nothing returned	13	These were the false negatives you suspected. Not empty — unreadable. Almost all load their artist lists with JavaScript
REVIEW — artist pages found, names unreadable	11	Artist pages provably exist; names could not be extracted. Definite under-counting
INCOMPLETE — stopped at a page limit	2	Singular stopped at exactly 5,000 pages, Monat at exactly 100. Limits, not endings
NO ARTISTS FOUND — genuinely none	12	Read successfully and correctly contain no artist listing — mostly suppliers

RESULT Of the **36 galleries** reporting zero artists, only **12 are genuinely empty**. The other **24 were wrong or unproven** — previously invisible.

STILL OUTSTANDING Reading JavaScript-rendered pages needs a browser-based reader, which is not yet built. Those 13 galleries are correctly flagged, but not yet fixed.

2. Artist discovery completeness

YOU ASKED FOR

“For each gallery, report: Total artists discovered. Total artists processed. This will allow us to compare the machine’s count with the actual number of artists on the gallery website and ensure it isn’t stopping after the first page or missing artists.”

BEFORE

Neither number existed. The machine reported only a rough “rich / thin / none” judgement per gallery, and never recorded how many artists it went on to process. There was no way to compare its count against reality.

CHANGED TO

Both numbers are recorded for every gallery and written to a spreadsheet, **coverage_report.csv**, one row per gallery — attached. It also shows how many pages were read, how many looked like artist pages, and what share of discovered artists were processed.

Gallery	Pages read	Discovered	Processed	Share
TERAVARNA	876	449	127	28%
Art Market Experts	971	345	44	13%
Atlantic Gallery	563	140	20	14%

Gallery	Pages read	Discovered	Processed	Share
World Illustration Awards	4,970	76	16	21%
Circle Foundation for the Arts	1,199	57	22	39%
International Guild of Realism	96	56	32	57%
Rome Art Week	873	52	20	38%
Visual Art Journal	1,694	50	30	60%
All 173 galleries	—	6,045	625	10%

RESULT The gap between discovered and processed is deliberate — processing stopped when the budget ran out, and only confirmed-female artists in proven galleries were processed at all. The point is that the gap is now **visible**, where before it was not.

3. Full gallery coverage

YOU ASKED FOR

“Verify that the machine follows all available artist listings until the end (e.g. pagination, “Next”, “Load More”, infinite scroll, alphabetical sections, etc.), so every artist on the gallery website is discovered before filtering begins.”

BEFORE

Artist names were read **only from page titles**. Many sites title every page with the site’s own name, so those artists were invisible. World Illustration Awards returned 4,970 pages and yielded just 40 names. Nothing flagged this — the gallery still looked processed.

CHANGED TO

Names are now read from **page titles and web addresses together**. */artist/maria-rossi* names the artist regardless of what the page title says. Multi-page listings and page limits are also detected and flagged on every row.

Discovery method	Artists found	What this shows
Page titles only (<i>the old method</i>)	2,409	What the machine could see before
Web addresses only	4,338	Works where titles are useless
Both combined (now)	6,045	The true count across 173 galleries
Previously missed	3,636	60% of all artists were invisible

RESULT Discovery rose from 2,409 to **6,045 artists**. **29 galleries** are flagged as having multi-page listings and **2** as having hit a page limit — their counts are labelled as a floor, not a total.

STILL OUTSTANDING Automatically clicking “Next” and “Load More” is not built. It needs the same browser-based reader as point 1 — one change would fix both.

4. Verification report

YOU ASKED FOR

“Once the above is implemented, I’d like to review a sample of galleries where we can compare: The gallery’s actual artist count. The number of artists discovered by the machine. The number of artists processed by the machine.”

BEFORE

No such report existed, and two of your three columns were not recorded anywhere, so the comparison could not be made even by hand.

CHANGED TO

coverage_report.csv is attached — every gallery, with pages read, artist pages seen, artists found by each method, artists discovered, artists processed, whether the listing is paginated, whether a page limit was hit, a plain-English verdict, and a *trusted yes / no* column you can filter on.

RESULT Two of your three columns are delivered for all 173 galleries. **106 are marked trusted**; **67 are flagged for a human check**.

STILL OUTSTANDING The third column — **the gallery's own stated artist count** — cannot be generated automatically. **Pick any five galleries** from the spreadsheet and I will count them by hand and send the three-way comparison.

5. Variety testing (reliability and scalability)

YOU ASKED FOR

“Test the machine against a diverse batch of galleries with different website structures, CMSs and navigation patterns to ensure the pipeline is reliable and scalable, rather than only working well for one specific type of gallery website.”

BEFORE

Never examined. There was no evidence either way about whether the machine only worked on one kind of website, because results were never grouped by site type or size.

CHANGED TO

The 173 galleries already read are themselves a varied sample, so I grouped them by size and measured the trust rate for each group. The website platform is now also recorded on every row of the report.

Site size (pages found)	Galleries	Trustworthy	Rate
Very large (1,000+)	42	29	69%
Large (201–1,000)	39	29	74%
Medium (51–200)	50	32	64%
Small (11–50)	17	11	65%
Tiny (1–10)	12	5	42%
Nothing returned	13	0	0%

RESULT The rate holds between **64% and 74%** from small sites to very large ones — good evidence the pipeline is not tuned to one kind of site. Failures are concentrated entirely in sites that returned nothing, which is the JavaScript problem again, not a scale problem.

STILL OUTSTANDING This is evidence from galleries already read, not a fresh test. **Genuine variety testing against new galleries on different platforms still needs running**, and I would want that done before either of us calls the machine reliable. It needs a web-reading budget.

6. Handoff

YOU ASKED FOR

“Once the above is complete, I'd like the whole process to be handed off so I can run the machine independently and carry out future testing myself.”

BEFORE

The only documentation was written for a developer. It explained how the code is organised, not how to operate the machine, and said nothing about how to check whether a run had missed anything.

CHANGED TO

HANDOFF.md is written and attached — plain English, no code reading required. Ten sections: the accounts you need, four setup commands, where to set the rules, how to add galleries, how to run it, how to watch the cost, **how to check the machine's work yourself**, how to confirm nothing is broken, troubleshooting, and the known limits.

The section that matters most for your purpose is **\$7, Checking the machine's work**. It explains every verdict and what to do about each one, and you can run it today, on already-saved data, at no cost:

```
python spikes/roster_probe/coverage_audit.py
```

RESULT You can run the machine and audit its coverage independently. Full independence also needs your own service keys — \$1 of the guide explains how to get them.

Additional reliability fixes, not on your list

Two problems surfaced while working on the above. Both affected the trustworthiness of the leads themselves, so I fixed them rather than leaving them for a later call.

Problem found	What was happening	The fix
Wrong email addresses counted as wins	A cookie-consent supplier's help desk, a gallery's sales office and a magazine platform's support address were all recorded as artists' emails. 114 of the first 140 records were affected.	An address or website appearing for more than one artist cannot belong to any single artist. The machine now stops as soon as it sees a repeat — which also cuts cost, because it stops before the expensive step
Broken addresses passing as valid	Text formatting around an address made the reader start part-way through, producing addresses like <code>_art@outlook.com</code> — valid in form, but reaching nobody.	Fragments are now rejected. Two of the three found were recoverable and the correct addresses were restored

RESULT Every figure in this document is from after those corrections. The lead count is deliberately the smaller, true number.

What I need from you

- **A web-reading budget top-up.** Every outstanding item needs live site reads. Roughly 1,000 credits would re-read the 24 problem galleries, follow the 29 multi-page listings, and run proper variety testing on a fresh batch.
- **Approval to build the browser-based reader first.** The 13 unreadable galleries, the 11 with unreadable names, and following “Next” and “Load More” all share one cause. A single change fixes all three, and it is the highest-value work outstanding.
- **Five galleries of your choosing** for the verification sample, so I can complete the three-way comparison you asked for in point 4.

On your closing point — that the objective is not perfection on every gallery, but a machine that is reliable, scalable and transparent, and that reports clearly when it cannot fully process a gallery: **that is now the rule it follows.** Twenty-four galleries are currently telling us honestly that they need attention, where previously they were counted as empty and passed over in silence.